

INTERNATIONAL news

TSMC and Samsung eyeing \$100 billion chip projects in UAE

Semiconductor giants TSMC and Samsung Electronics are discussing potential chip projects in the UAE, valued at over \$100 billion. TSMC executives visited to explore establishing a facility like their Taiwan plants, while Samsung is considering launching chip-making operations. Funding is expected to come from the UAE's Mubadala fund, which aims to boost global chip production.

Lebanon decides to increase imports of electronic products from China

Lebanon plans to import telecom products from China, citing safety concerns after Israeli air force attacks. Officials claim the West has lost credibility, prompting a shift towards Eastern technology. The conflict has damaged Israel's trade relations with China, which amounted to \$2.44 billion annually. The geopolitical tensions escalated following recent attacks by Hamas and Hezbollah.

Thailand's first SiC fab coming soon, \$350 million sanctioned

The Thailand Board of Investment is investing \$350 million in a joint venture with Hana Microelectronics and PTT to establish the country's first silicon carbide chip fabrication facility. Targeting electric vehicles and data centres, production is expected to begin in 2027. The project aims to create jobs and foster Thailand's electronics ecosystem.

Fujifilm to invest 20 billion yen for semiconductors production

Fujifilm plans to invest 20 billion yen to expand its semiconductor production unit in Japan, driven by rising demand for advanced chips in autonomous driving, AI, and 5G/6G communication. The investment includes 13 billion yen for a new facility in Yoshida and 7 billion yen in Oita to boost cleaner production capacity by 40%. The expansion aims to enhance development and quality inspection.

TSMC secures \$7.5 billion for Arizona operations expansion

TSMC has received approval for a \$7.5 billion investment in its Arizona subsidiary, boosting total funding to \$24 billion. This investment will enhance operations in Arizona, where TSMC is developing advanced fabrication facilities. The first fab is set to begin mass production next year, while plans for a third fab focused on 2nm technology are underway.

US grants \$123 million to Polar Semiconductor for expansion

The US Commerce Department has approved a \$123 million grant for Polar Semiconductor to expand its Minnesota facility, nearly doubling its production capacity for power and sensor chips. This initiative, part of the Biden administration's \$52.7 billion semiconductor plan, aims to bolster the US manufacturing for aerospace, automotive, and defence sectors with additional funding from Minnesota.

US NSF announces \$42.4 million for semiconductor research initiative

The US National Science Foundation (NSF) announced \$42.4 million in grants for its 'Future of Semiconductors' (NSF FuSe2)

initiative, partnering with companies like Ericsson and Intel. This funding will support 23 research projects across 15 states, focusing on semiconductor technologies, energy efficiency, and next-generation materials while promoting diversity in STEM education.

Poland secures \$1.9 billion EU approval for Intel chip plant

The European Commission has approved Poland's plan to provide over \$1.91 billion in state aid for an Intel chip plant, part of the EU's semiconductor policy. The total investment is projected to exceed 25 billion zlotys from 2024-2026 and aims to boost Europe's chip market share.

Intel and AWS partner for custom chip manufacturing

Intel has partnered with Amazon Web Services (AWS) to co-invest in its internal foundry, focusing on custom chip designs, including an AI fabric chip and a custom Xeon 6 chip. Manufacturing will occur at Intel's \$28 billion Ohio facilities, enhancing collaboration and supporting a sustainable domestic AI supply chain. AWS is also expanding its data centres in central Ohio.

UK acquires US semiconductor factory to safeguard defence value chain

The UK government has acquired a crucial semiconductor factory in Newton Aycliffe to prevent supply chain disruptions for its armed forces. The facility, purchased from American company Coherent Inc. for approximately £20 million, is the only secure site in the UK for manufacturing gallium arsenide chips. The acquisition secures up to 100 jobs and enhances military capabilities.

Scotland steps up, £5.5 million for green electronics manufacturing

The UK has launched a £5.5 million sustainable electronics design and manufacturing centre, REACT, in Scotland. The centre aims to revolutionise the industry through greener practices. Coordinated by the University of Glasgow and supported by UK Research and Innovation, it will tackle environmental challenges and support collaboration among academia and industry to reduce waste and emissions.

Advanced Energy opens new facility in Greater Boston

Advanced Energy has opened a new design and service centre in Wilmington, Massachusetts, to bolster local talent and innovation in the Boston tech corridor. This facility will focus on developing power technologies for semiconductor, industrial, and medical applications, housing up to 50 employees and enhancing the company's growth strategy in precision power technologies.

EnSilica and SIAE collaborate on advanced wireless chips

SIAE MICROELETTRONICA has partnered with EnSilica to develop application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs) for its telecommunications infrastructure to enhance power efficiency and reduce costs. This ten-year collaboration focuses on integrating SIAE's designs into custom ASICs, minimising development risks. The partnership will support innovative modem chips and contribute to mobile communications and microelectronics advancements.